Endpoint routing is fundamental to all but the simplest ASP.NET Core apps. It's implemented with two pieces of middleware, which you've already seen:

- `EndpointRoutingMiddleware`—This middleware chooses which registered endpoints execute for a given request at runtime. To make it easier to distinguish between the two types of middleware, I'll be referring to this middleware as the `RoutingMiddleware` throughout this book.
- `EndpointMiddleware`—This middleware is typically placed at the end of your middleware pipeline. The middleware *executes* the endpoint selected by the `RoutingMiddleware` at runtime.

You register the endpoints in your application by calling `Map*` functions on an `IEndpointRouteBuilder` instance. In .NET 7 apps, this instance typically is a `Web-Application` instance but doesn't have to be, as you'll see in chapter 30.

DEFINITION An *endpoint* in ASP.NET Core is a handler that returns a response. Each endpoint is associated with a URL pattern. Depending on the type of application you're building, minimal API handlers, Razor Page handlers, or MVC controller action methods typically make up the bulk of the endpoints in an application. You can also use simple middleware as an endpoint or you could use a health-check endpoint, for example.

`WebApplication` implements `IEndpointRouteBuilder`, so you can register endpoints on it directly. Listing 6.1 shows how you'd register several endpoints:

- A minimal API handler using `MapGet()`, as you've seen in previous chapters.